King Kaitaba

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King Kaitaba ruled the central Haya Kingdom of Kyamtwara in the middle of the 19th century. Son of Kitekere, the founder of the Bankango dynasty, Kaitaba stands heroically amidst the symbols, instruments, and prerogatives of royal rule. Just as his father does in his own ballad included in this library, Kaitaba rises up under grave provocation and thoroughly defeats the armies of a neighboring king. We see in him both the acme and the pivot of institutional power in the centralized state he commands.

But the seams in Kaitaba's mantle of state power have become more visible, even frayed. To be sure, we see the king confirm the unity of his state and bring glory to its name on the battlefield. But the origin both of the unease he feels from the very beginning of the story and of the driving force of disequilibrium that the plot eventually resolves come from within his own state.

That force originates in the manly high spirits of the miteeko, the cohorts of warriors from a single locality, who have been educated together as youths at the royal compound, have done heavy labor like clearing land for the state economy, and most importantly, have fought together as warriors if and when this was necessary. Their appetites for battle and its spoils are seen to be difficult to constrain. The cohorts seem to challenge Kaitaba to be more like the dominant figure his dynasty-founding father was.

The elaboration of power relationships in this picture of the state seems reflected in the ballad's complex poetic form, which is baroque in comparison with those of other works in the genre. The composer - who is said to be the famous Kyamtwara bard Magangala - has intensified and multiplied the poetic features found in other works in the genre, creating a highly structured stylistic surface for the poem.

Another remarkable feature of the ballad is its coda, which envisions warriors returning from victorious battle. In the column are Kaitaba's successors, who in various ways, at the end of the 19th century and the beginning of the 20th, fell afoul of German colonial rule. They are pictured crying as they proceed homeward from their campaign.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 1-17:
Action begins at night as a sleepless, troubled King Kaitaba seeks counsel from a court favorite.

Lines 18-36:
Their consultation reveals the problem: the king's warrior subjects have not been fulfilling their obligation to pay regular visits to the court. The councilor suggests sounding the royal drums at daybreak to see how the warriors answer the call.

NOTES

4 Spoke royally, the Creator: Special vocabularies describe activities and attributes of kings (and of brides and spirit mediums); the singer puns on the word *oku-hanga*, which means "to create" in most contexts, including the king's praise name, and can also mean "to speak" when its subject is royal.

13 Among the Balwani: = at the guardhouse; in Kyamutwala kingdom the Balwani clan provided guardians to the king.

16 Kaboneke: Literally, "may it appear," is the most polite way to answer being called or addressed. {Sun}: a praise name for the king.

18 Banoina: Lushuli seems to have been a slip of the tongue. {Asked no other word}: not literally, as the following line shows; this often repeated phrase indicates single-minded resolve - one asks no other questions of oneself.

At night in the damp darkness,
It was night in the damp darkness,
Damp darkness when winds cease their howl.
Spoke he royally, the *Creator of broad courtyards*.
Come see him speak, the *Creator of good fortune* .

I heard him say, "Lushuli,
Lushuli, *Uprooter of underbrush*,
Quickly! Find for me Banoina,
Banoina, the *Royal chef*.
Have him come and counsel me.
This day I would be counselled."

He went, he called him, Lushuli,
He called him among the Balwani.
"He calls you, the *Creator of broad courtyards*,
He calls you, the *Creator of good fortune."*
He answered, "Your will be done, O *Sun* ."
That day he came running, truly, truly.

[Enanga Solo]

He asked no other word Banoina.
What has taken hold of you, my king?"
He said, "What has taken hold of me, my man–
Now see, I am confounded, truly, truly–

Omu kilo omu itumbi omu itumbi,
Kikaba ekilo omu itumbi,
Eitumbi biyaga byayanga kutengya.
Yahanga *Luhanga-malembo*.
Ij' olebe nahanga *Luhanga-mugisha*.

Nkahulila ati, "Lushuli,
Lushuli, *Nyamulandula*,
Iloko ompigile Banoina,
Banoina, *Omukologo*.
Aij' ampanule,
Kil' ekya mbwenu nagonza kuhanulwa."

Yagya yamweta Lushuli,
Yamweta omuli Bulwani.
"Nakweta, *Luhanga-Malembo*,
Nakweta, *Luhanga-Mugisha."*
Ati, "Kaboneke *Eizoba*."
Kil' eki yaija ailukile bwoli bwoli.

[Enanga Solo]

Tiyabaliz' ekindi Lushuli.
"Ekyakukwata mukama wange?"
Ati, "Ekyonkweteile, mushaija wange -
Mbwenu leba nashobelwa bwoli bwoli --

POETIC STANZAS

1-5: stanza in **aabb** - with one line (2) the result of a repetition for emphasis - formed by contrast between a couplet that coheres by chained repetition (1-3) and one that coheres by parallelism.

6-17: verse of two compound stanzas (6-11 and 12-17), both **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2; the first compound stanza (6-11) is formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by chained repetition and a parallelism created by the second line of each being composed as name + praisename (6-7 and 8-9) and a couplet (10-11) that coheres by repetition of a form of *oku-hanula* ("to counsel") in final position; the second compound stanza (12-17) is formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by parallelism lexical repetition (12-13, 14-15) and one that seems not to cohere; the verse coheres by virtue of the repeated, structurally similar six line units, and by virtue of the fact that the final line of each (11, 17) begins with the repeated commonplace *Kil' ek-*, "this day"; the verse is finalized by repeating the adverb *bwoli*, "truly"at the end of the last line.

18-21: stanza in **abbc** formed by incremental repetition of the verb *oku-kwata*, "to take hold of"inflected in a relative form and parallelism created by composition as noun phrase (relative verb) + address + pronoun in the two middle lines (19-20);

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 37-61:
At daybreak the drum sounds and one by one battalions attend, ask what the matter is, and receive a deferring response.

NOTES

22 Muhyoza: (pl. bahyoza) the name collectively applied to the inhabitants of Kyamutwala kingdom.

23 Nyamugenya: a commonly heard praise, but apparently its meaning has been forgotten.

25 Hunter-of-the-Steppes: praise name for Kaitaba, the king. {Salute}: Greetings are important markers and acknowledgements of rank and Kaitaba's complaint foreshadows the vulnerability he later shows to status insult. Although historically a powerful ruler, he was not a member of the Hinda clan that held legitimate power in other kingdoms of Hayaland.

32 Roan Bull: praise name for one of Kaitaba's royal drums.

33 Obliterator-of-Borders: another drum praise name.

35 Go to war: the Bahyoza's love of battle is legendary.

POETIC STANZAS

22-25: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with interrogatives (**a**'s: 22,24) and those that end with a praisename (**b**'s: 23,25).

30-40: verse in **aba'** of three linegroups that cohere by incremental repetition; the first linegroup of three lines is apparently a truncated quatrain (30-32); the other two are full quatrains; the first and third linegroups are almost identical, except for truncation and the fact they are framed as quoted speech and narration, respectively; it seems if the first linegroup were a full quatrain it would be linked to the second by incremental repetition also; the final line of the final linegroup finalizes the figure with the standard phrase "that day"; second quatrain (33-36) is a stanza in **aaab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a verb inflected in the first person plural and a line with no verb consisting of a praisename.

What has become of the Muhyoza,
Raffia skirt Nyamugenya?
For eight days now
They have not come to greet the *Hunter of the steppes*.

I fear the Muhyoza,
I fear, my man."
He answered, "Hold and let me counsel you,
My king."

He said, "When we judge it to be daybreak,
Daybreak–the giant sun is a gout of blood–
We'll sound, we'll salute the *Roan bull*.

We'll salute the *Obliterator of borders*.
We'll raise a roar with the *Roan bull*.
Then we'll see how they come out for war, the Muhyoza,
Raffia skirt Nyamugenya."

When they judged it to be daybreak,
Daybreak–the giant sun is a gout of blood–
They sounded the *Obliterator of borders*.
That day they raised a roar with the *Roan bull*.

Babaileki Omuhyoza,
Kashenshe Nyamugenya?
Nka bamala ebilo munana
Bataikulamya *Kishwaga-Malungu*.

Natina Muhyoza,
Natina, mushaija wange."
Ahi, "Leka mpanule,
Mukama wange."

Ahi, "Katulalenga bwankya,
Bwankya ekizoba kyaba njuba,
Tulengese tulamye *Lugaju*.

Tulamye *Itaba-Mbibi*.
Tutagalule na *Lugaju*.
Tulabona olwo balatabala Muhyoza,
Kashenshe Nyamugenya."

Kabalengile bwankya,
Bwankya ekizoba kyaba njuba,
Balamya *Itaba-Mbibi*.
Kil' eki batagalula *Lugaju*.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 62-79:
The king proceeds to the assembly point with regal mien and receives the gathered warriors' salutations.

NOTES

43 Kabale: the traditional seat of Kyamutwala rule.

45 Leper: praise name for a drum used to signal the onset of war.

50 Troop: Regionally organized troops (*emiteeko)* provided military and other forms of service to the kings; a form of age-grade education brought young men to the palace for periods of training and labor.

53 Smudge fire: When they return from pasture, cattle are traditionally made to pass over a smoky fire to drive away insects; an especially brave, strong-willed bull might act out his dislike of this by stamping on the burning brush.

60 Mirth-makers: literally, "He who causes all to laugh," that is, makes all (except the enemy) happy with their military exploits.

63 Kabahula: apparently the place where announcements were made; *kabahule* means "let them hear."

POETIC STANZAS

41-44: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that are constructed as verb initial + subject (**a**'s: 41, 43) and lines that consist of the subject's praisename (**b**'s: 42, 44).

41-61: verse in **aab** of three linegroups (41-49, 50-55, 56-61) with mirrored structure; each linegroup consists of couplets composed as verb initial/ Ø verb appositive or praisename of the previous line's subject, a pattern that is varied to create finalizations; the three linegroups share virtually the same final line (49, 55, and 61), which alters the couplet pattern just noted and finalizes each linegroup; the first linegroup is somewhat irregular and is the result, I believe, both of an expansion of the pattern clearly evident in the succeeding linegroups and of the noted interruption in the performance; if we regard lines 43-45 as expansions of the pattern, perhaps truncated by interruption, then the pattern of the verse can be seen as consisting of three six-line stanzas constructed as mirror images of one another (41-42 + 46-49, 50-55 and 56- 61); based on couplets composed as verb initial/ Ø verb, the six line stanza has the following pattern: initial verb of attendance (or hearing) + proper noun/ praise/ interrogative form of "to be"/ address or praise of King/ initial imperative/ final line essentially repeated; the first two stanzas are finalized by the third (56-61), which varies the pattern by being composed solely of the alternation - inital verb of attendance + proper noun/ praise - except for its final line, which it shares with the other stanzas; it also introduces and repeats *teka* "assemble"in alternating lines, a verb that links this final and finalizing stanza to the stanza that follows.

62-65: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines with verb initial (**a**'s: 62, 64) and those with Ø verb (**b**'s: 63, 65); note the conrast with previous figure in Ø verb line begins with preposition (63) and the second verb initial is inflected to refer to King rather than followers (64); prepositional constructions and royal subject are expanded in the following stanza.

They listened, the Muhyoza,
Raffia skirt Nyamugenya.
"What has happened to the King of Kabale,
King *Hunter of the steppes?*

Since they did not beat the *Leper* . . ."

[Interruption–children playing too loudly shooed away]

"What has happened, *Father-creator* ,
My king?"
He said, "Quickly! To the courtyard at the rocky outcrop!
It is I who have all facts."

They attended, the Mulalamba troop,
Who drive all before them .
"What has happened? What has happened,
O *Bull who stamps smudge fires?* "
He said, "Quickly! To the rocky outcrop!
It is I who will make known all facts."

They went and gathered on the rocky outcrop,
Raffia skirt Nyamugenya.
They gathered, the Nourished-by-the-Clash-of-Battle troop,
Big foot of Lwanda.
They gathered, the Mirth-makers troop.
"It is I," he said, "who will make known the facts."

They gathered on the rocky outcrop.
At Kabahula, that very place.
He arose, the *Creator of broad courtyards,*
The *Creator of good fortune.*

Bahulila Omuhyoza,
Kashenshe Nyamugenya.
"Yabaki omukama wa Kabale,
Omukama *Kishwaga-Malungu?*

K'Omubembe tibagiteile..."

[Interruption]

"Wabaki *Ishowanga*
Mukama wange?"
Ahi, "Iloko Nyalulembo omu lwazi,
Amakulu gona gaina 'nye."

Bahulula Omulalamba,
Nyakabinga.
"Wabaki, wabaki,
Enumi ya Kijunga-Makomi?"
Ahi, "Iloko na inywe omu bwazi.
Amakulu gona galamanywa 'nye."
[Enanga Solo]
Bagenda bateka omu bwazi,
Kashenshe Nyamugenya.
Yateka Omulya-Mpuulo,

Kigele kya Lwanda.
Yateka Omushekya-Bona.
"Amakulu," ati, "Galamanywa 'nye."

Bateka omu bwazi.
Omwa Kabahula mwonene.
Yabandatuka *Luhanga-Malembo,*
Luhanga-Mugisha.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 80-89:
Kaitaba asks why the warriors avoid him and is told the reason is a lack of sorghum — that is, there is no beer.

Lines 90-119:
The king immediately sends an emissary to the king of Kiziba to request the use of land for growing sorghum. The emissary makes arrangements to have his travelling party received at his own house on the way.

NOTES

67 Fire: see note to line 53.

68 Iron bars: chimes hung on the gate to the palace forecourt to signal its movement.

69 Did not question: see note to line 18

84 Sorghum: the principal ingredient for beer; the lack of land for its cultivation is said to be a problem in Kyamutwala. A major part of the hospitality expected from kings by their subjects was beer, and its absence here has prevented the regular palace attendance expected of respectful subjects.

85 Kyatulambala: the causitive form, *kyatulambaza*, is said to be more correct here.

99 this last line of praise is not completely clear in meaning.

POETIC STANZAS

66-69: stanza in **aaab** by virtue of contrast between lines that include a prepositional particles and palace locations, and one that does not.

70-73: stanza in **abbb** by virtue of contrast between lines that have bodypart initial (71-73) and one that does not (70); figure could also be **aabb** composed of couplets that cohere by enjambment (70-71) and parallelism (72-73) respectively.

74-79: compound stanza in **aab** of three couplets composed as greeting + praisename/ shared last line; the final couplet (78-79) finalizes the figure by transforming the composition: greeting is narrated rather than quoted, praisename is that of the speaker rather than that of the addressee, and the last line has added words.

80-85: compound stanza in **aba'** of three couplets; formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by enjambment (**a**'s:80-81, 84-85) and one that coheres by parallelism and repetition (82-83).

86-89: stanza composed, alternately, in **aabb** as two couplets that cohere by parallelism and repetition (**a**'s: 86-87) and by parallelism alone (2nd person plural verb initial) and enjambment; or in **aaab** formed by contrast between lines that have a double verb (to be + main verb) in past perfect in (near) initial position (**a**'s:86-88) and a single line that begins with a single negative verb (**b**:89).

90-93: stanza in **abab** of two couplets that both cohere by chaining of an already repeated word.

94-99: stanza: **aaabbb** in six lines formed by contrast between lines composed as "tell" + praisename (**a**'s: 94-96) and lines composed as praisename alone (**b**'s: 97-99).

I saw him in the center of the palace forecourt.
At the fire of the Brown-flecked Bull,
At the iron bars that chime a warning,
He asked no questions coming.

Into the palace courtyard,
With folded arms he came.
His eyes sought not the Bahyoza.
His eyes sought Kagondo village.

"Long life, *Creator of broad courtyards* !"
Then they fell in a stony silence.
"Long life, *Unwavering one* !"
Then they fell in a stony silence.
They saluted, the Nourished by the Clash of Battle,
And they also fell in a stony silence.

He said, "What has become of you, Bahyoza,
That you speak no words to me?"
They said, "We hunger, O *Sun*.
We hunger, we are pained to hunger so.
We lack the land for growing sorghum:
Lord, that is why we hunger so"

He said, "And I had been confounded, Muhyoza,
I had been confounded, my men.
You'd gone for eight full days
Without once greeting the *Hunter of the steppes* ."

He summoned Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa,
"Ngimbwa, my man,
Go, be quick, be quick,
Be quick and go for me to the kingdom of Kiziba.

Go and tell him, the *Owner of bottom land*,
Tell him, *Calves like iron hammers*,
Tell him, *Hafted knife that cleaves great trees*,
Axe that makes the forest roar,
Child of Born among kings and Breast-giving comforter
Wilderness, he comes from Kishuga Ngalama.

Nkabona nyakabuga omugati,
Aha komi ya Lugondo.
Omu ibobo lwantakya,
Tiyabalize kugenda.

Nyalulembo
Emikono akaija ashobejainyie.
Amaisho tagahangile Bahyoza.
Amaisho gahangile Kagondo.

"Kamelele *Luhanga-Malembo*!"
Bayesiza kaba kahuna.
"Kamelele *Ntalalila*!"
Bayesiza kaba kahuna.
Balamya Omulya-mpuulo,
Na bonene bayesiza kaba kahuna.

Ahi, "Mwabaki Bahyoza,
Nka mutaikugamba bigambo?"
Bati, "Twalambala Izoba.
Twalambala twaitwa okulambala.
Twabulwa obulimo bw' omugusha:
Waitu nikyo kyatulambala."

Ahi, "Nanye mbaile nshobeilwe, Muhyoza,
Mbaile nshobeilwe, bashaija bange.
Mubaile mumazile ebilo munana
Mutaikulamya *Kishwaga-Malungu*."

Yabilikila Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa
"Ngimbwa, mushaija wange,
Ogende noiluka, noiluka,
Noiluka ongendelele Kiziba.

Ogend' ogy' omugambile *Lwa Nyempita*,
Omugambile *Mfundo-nyondo*,
Omugambile *Muholo Atema-biti*,
Mbaizi Abologya-kibila,
Owa Kabakama na Kyonkya-bukizi
Bitalaka aluga omwa Kishuga Ngalama.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 120-149:
The emissary's wife prepares for the travelers and receives them. They eat, are refreshed, and continue on their way.

NOTES

101 Kitekele: Kaitaba's father and previous king of Kyamutwala. {Luyobya}: king of Kiziba at that time.

115 The sequence of tenses suggests alacrity and its consequences: beginning with the unmarked *-a-* past, the movement is fixed in time with the *-ka-*, and then completed with the *-ile* perfect. The following line picks up the string of the narrative again with the unmarked *-a-*.

POETIC STANZAS

100-105: compound stanza in **aab** of three couplets; formed by contrast between couplets that begin with a locutive (**a**'s:100-101, 102-103) and one that does not (**b**:104-105); the first couplet coheres by apposition, the second by parallelism and repetition, and the third by parallelism alone (3rd plural verb in near past in initial position); formed after 80-85

106-119: verse of mirror stanzas (106-113 and 114-119) formed by repetition; the first linegroups (106-109 and 114-115) share an initial formulaic phrase "he did not ask another word"; the second linegroups (110-111 and 115-116) both begin with the root */genda/* "go" (first position, first line) and end with "Kaiyula," a woman's name (final position, final line), and both couplets cohere by virtue of verb initial parallelism; the third linegroups (112-113 and 118-119) share initial locutives and final words.

120-123: stanza in **aabb** of couplets that cohere by apposition and chaining, respectively.

124-127: stanza in **a**a**ba'** formed by contrast between lines that have verb initial (**a**'s: 124, 125, 127) and one line that has no verb (**b**: 126).

128-131: stanza in **abac** formed by contrast between lines whose final word is repeated three times (**a**'s: 128, 130) and lines that lack this feature; the stanza is composed of couplets that cohere by enjambment and apposition, respectively.

Say, 'By that blood brotherhood
Sworn by Kitekele and Luyobya:'
Say, 'They hunger, the Bahyoza,
They hunger, the *Raffia skirt Nyamugenya*.
They lack the land for growing sorghum:
They are pained to hunger so.'"

He asked no further word, Ngimbwa.
He summoned his child, Kajoki.
"Kajoki, Kajoki
Kajoki, my child,
Go, be quick, travel home to Katoma.
Speak to your mother, Kaiyula.
Say, "He'll be brought this way with Muhyoza
Tomorrow. The king has sent him to Kiziba.'"

The child asked no other word.
He travelled, he went and was quick.
He travelled to his father's house.
He found his mother, Kaiyula.
He said, "Father is behind me. He'll come with Muhyoza.
The king has sent him to Kiziba."

At the time she was there,
Kaiyula, Kaiyula, Kaiyula . . .
She cooked some yams,
Yams she had harvested in Itahwa.

She peeled the yams.
She hurried and put them in a basket.
Calabashes of beer that day,
She set out truly, truly.

At the time she was there, there, there,
She was surprised to see Bahyoza.
Among them was Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa,
Bad dream of the Makuba.

An ancient feud fixed a scar above his eye.
Child of Bushalita,
And Settler of disputes.
They call him *Child of Muyego maiden, Long-necked giraffe*.

Oti, 'Omukago 'gwomwanywaine,
Ogwa Kitekele na Luyobya:'
Ohi, 'Balambala Abahyoza,
Balambala *Kashenshe Nyamugenya*.
Babulwa obulimo bw' omugusha.
Baitwa okulambala.'"

Tiyabaliz' ekindi Ngimbwa.
Akabilikila omwanawe Kajoki.
"Kajoki, Kajoki
Kajoki, mwana wange,
Ogende noiluka ogye Katoma omwaitu.
Omugambile nyoko Kaihyula.
Oti, 'Alaletwaho n' Omuhyoza
Nyenkya. Omukama yamutuma Kiziba.'"

Omwana tiyabaliz' ekindi.
Yagenda akagenda ailukile.
Yagenda kaishemu.
Yamushangamu nyina Kaiyula.
Ahi, "Tata ali enyuma. Alaija n' Omuhyoza.
Omukama yamutuma Kiziba."

Kayabaile aliho wenene,
Kaiyula, Kaiyula, Kaiyula...
Akabachumbil' ebikwala,
Ebikwala kaba abihiile Itahwa.

Yatondola ebikwala.
Yayanguha yateka aha katalo.
Engunda y' amalwa kil' ekyo,
Yabiteka bwoli bwoli

Kayabaile aliho aliho aliho,
Abechula Abahyoza.
Bainamu Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa, Ngimbwa,
Ihunga lya Makuba.

Obulwani bw' eila bukamukwasa enkoju aha lisho.
Wa Bushalita,
Na Muchwa-mpaka.
Bamweta *Omwana wa Mukayego Lutwiga*.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 150-172:
They march northward through named landmarks.

POETIC STANZAS

136-139: stanza in **aa**a**b** formed by contrast between lines that begin with locutives and consist of quoted discourse (**a**'s: 136-138) and a line that does neither (**b**: 139); alternately, the stanza can be read as **aabb** formed by couplets that cohere by repetition: of "my wife" (**a**'s: 136-137) and of "greet" (**b**'s: 138-139).

140-143: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that have no verb (**a**'s: 140, 142) and lines that have one (**b**'s: 141, 143).

144-147: stanza in **abba'** formed by contrast between lines in which the verb is (near) initial and precedes its direct object (**a**'s: 144, 147) and lines in which the direct object is initial and precedes its verb, which may be present or implied (**b**'s: 145, 146).

148-151: stanza in **abab** formed by couplets that cohere by chaining and chained placenames.

152-155: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that consist of a place designation (**a**'s: 152, 154) and lines that consist of a formulaic phrase (**b**'s: 153, 155); couplets cohere by enjambment.

156-172: verse passage in **abab** of 4 stanzas formed by contrast between stanzas in **aab** (**a**'s: 156-158, 163-166) and stanzas in **abab** (**b**'s: 159-162, 167-172); in all stanzas, **a**'s are lines that include placenames but no verbs and **b**'s are lines that begin with "I saw" (the single exception being 168) followed by a verb inflected in 3rd person near past; in the stanzas formed as **aab** (156-158, 163-166), 2 or 3 type **a** lines are finalized by a single type **b**; in stanzas formed as **abab** (159-162, 167-172), the types alternate.

He said, "My wife." She said, "My lord."
He said, "I've come my wife."
She said, "I give you greeting, my lord."
She gives greetings to the men of the *Hunter of the steppes*.

A harvest basket
Of yams she brought,
With serving basket to the dining place.
With banana-pith towel they towel their hands.

They eat the yams.
A pipe-full of tobacco they wish to puff.
A calabash of beer . . .
That day they had no need to ask.

They say, "We're going now,
We're going now, my wife."
They descend to Kijululuzi village.
Past Kempongwa hill they march their march.

At Kigalama of Entahi,
They did not ask a word.
At that very place, that very place,
They did not speak a word.

At Byeshekaima at the home of Kishenya,
At Kyambu, Kyambu, Kyambu,
I saw them truly, truly cross the water.

At Kinoba village,
I saw them climb their climb.
At Kashaka of the copses,
I saw them push on to Katenda.

At Kashaka of the copses,
That day at Kyendanzigu as well,
At Katendagulo, just there,
I saw their determined march.

Through the Swamp of Defeat,
They marched their march.
At the Steppe of the Wild Figs,
I saw their determined march.
In Kijunja vilage, that very place,
I saw their determined march.

Ahi, "Mukazi wange." Ahi, "Waitu."
Ahi, "Naizile mukazi wange."
Ahi, "Shula, waitu."
Abashula bashaija ba *Kishwaga-Malungu*.

Akagega
Yakaleta ak' ebikwala,
Akatalo omu ibanga ebikwala.
Akashuumu balagaza bulagazi.

Babilya ebikwala.
Eiyembe ly' etaba bagonza kushokola.
Engunda y' amalwa...
Kil' ekyo tibabaliz' ekigambo.

Bahi, "Twagenda,
Twagenda, mukazi wange."
Basongoka omuli Kijululuzi.
Kempongwa bagenda bugenzi.

Kigalama ky' entahi,
Tibabaliz' ebigambo.
Mwonene mwonene,
Tibagambil' ekigambo.

Byeshekaima omwa Kishenya,
Kyambu, Kyambu, Kyambu,
Nkabona bayambuka bwoli bwoli.

Omu Kinoba,
Nkabona batemba butembi.
Kashaka k' enshaka,
Nkabona bashubize Katenda.

Kashaka k' enshaka,
Kil' ekyo na Kyendanzigu,
Katendagulo mwonene,
Nkabona bagonza kugenda.

Omu lushanga lwa Kileme,
Bagenda bugenzi.
Kanyamuheshelwa k' amashasha,
Nkabona bagonza kugenda.
Omuli Kijunja mwonene,
Nkabona bagonza kugenda.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 173-197:
They arrive at the palace, observe the royal protocol, and state the reason for their mission.

Lines 198-223:
The king of Kiziba receives them well and grants their request. The travelling party thank him, return home, and report their success to Kaitaba.

NOTES

189 Ancient Boar: praise of Kaitaba; a boar grows ancient by defeating hunters. {Makes hunters wary}: Wild pigs are often hunted in dense, high elephant grass, so that a hunter may have to confront quite suddenly and alone a large, angry boar.

POETIC STANZAS

173-177: 173-177.1: compound stanza in **ab**b**a'**, 1 + 2 + 2 + 1, formed by contrast between single formulaic lines (**a**'s: 173, 177.1) and couplets that cohere by apposition of praise and of description, respectively (**b**'s: 174-175 and 176-177).

178-181: stanza in **ab**b**a'** formed by contrast between lines composed as adverbial (of place or time) + main verb (**a**'s: 178, 181) and lines that end with "Balongo,"the officer's name (**b**'s: 179, 180).

182-185: stanza in **aabb** formed by couplets that cohere by repetition, respectively of */luga/* "come from"in initial position (**a**'s: 182-183) and */lamya/* "salute royally" in final position (**b**'s: 184-185).

186-189: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that have a verb initial (**a**'s: 186-188) and a single line that has no verb (**b**:189)

192-197: compound stanza in **aba'**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that are composed as locutive initial…/Ø verb and cohere by enjambment (**a**'s: 192-193, 196-197) and a single couplet that is composed as locutive initial…/NP+VP and coheres semantically as request/ justification (**b**:194-195).

198-201: stanza in **aab** formed - after a formulaic line (198) that links the stanza to the pattern of call-and-response between king and visitors (173, 186) - by contrast between lines that begin with a 3rd person plural verb and contain two such verbs and a single line that begins similarly, but contains only one such verb.

They did not ask another word.
The king,
Owner of bottom land, Great-calfed one
In Kijunja, that very place,
  Is where the palace then was.
They did not ask a thing.

At the courtyard gate they met them.
The officer of the watch was Balongo.
"Long life, Balongo."
That day he returned their respect truly, truly.

"Where do you come from, Bahyoza?"
They said, "We come from the *Hunter of the steppes*.
He says he salutes, he salutes,
His desire is to come and salute."

They did not ask another word.
They went and told the king.
He said, "Quickly! Let them come in, the men of the
  Great-calfed one,
Of the *Ancient boar*, *Child of Makes hunters wary*. "

As they still approached, "Respectful greetings,
Live forever, *O Sun*.

He salutes you, he salutes you,
The *Bull who stamps smudge fires*.
He would like you to give him land for growing sorghum.
The Bahyoza are pained to hunger so.
He would like you to remember the blood brotherhood
Sworn by Kitekele and Luyobya."

[Enanga solo]

He did not ask another word.
He said, "Go cook plantains for them."
They cooked plantains. They ate.
They wished to bid farewell.

Tibabaliz' ekindi.
Omukama,
Lwa Nyahiita Nfundo
Omuli Kijunja mwonene,
  Nimwo ekikale kyabaile kili.
Tibabaliz' akantu.

Nyalulembo bakabashangamu.
Omukumilizi aba ali Balongo.
"Shumalamu, Balongo."
Kil' ekyo yabaikiliza bwoli bwoli.

"Mwaluga nkaha Bahyoza?"
Bahi, "Twaluga omwa Kishwaga-Malungu.
Ngu wenene nalamya, nalamya,
Nagonza kugya kulamya."

Tibabaliz' ekindi.
Bagya bamugambila.
Ahi, "Iloko! Baije abashaija ba *Nfundo*,

Aba *Mpunu Nkulu lwa Kabakenga*."

Okwo basingile bakyaija, "Shamalama,
Kamelele *Izoba*.

Ngu nakulamya nakulamya,
Enumi ya Kijunga-Makomi.
Ngu omuhe obulimo bw' omugusha.
Omuhyoza baitw' okulambala.
Ngu oijuke omukago 'gwomwanywaine,
Ogwa Kitekele na Luyobya."

[Enanga solo]

Tiyabaliz' ekindi.
Ati, "Bagende bagye babachumbile ebitoke."
Babichumba ebitoke. Babilya.
Bagonza kulaga.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 224-249:
Kaitaba summons his warriors and they go to cultivate the sorghum. When it ripens, some try to steal it, but Kaitaba uses a spiritual healer to draw off the sorcery that caused the bad behavior.

NOTES

211 Redden: That is, to cultivate the land for planting and reveal the red clay earth.

POETIC STANZAS

202-211: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2 + 2 + 2, formed by: contrast between couplets composed as …placename…/ repeated phrase ("Let them turn it to bare earth,"**a**'s: 202-203, 204-205, 206-207, 208-209) and a single couplet composed as …placename/ synonymous phrase ("let them redden it quite red,"**b**: 210-211).

212-215: stanza that coheres by initial 3rd plural verbs and seems to be in **abab**, formed by contrast between lines composed of Verb + Substantive (**a**'s: 212, 214, verb + subject and verb + direct object, respectively) and lines composed as Verb + non-substative (**b**'s: 213, 215, verb + prepositional phrase and verb + infinitive, respectively).

216-225: compound stanza (2 + (2 + 2 + 2) + 2) in **aba'** formed by contrast between couplets that cohere by a chained repetition of lima "cultivate" (**a**'s: 216-217, 224-225) and three intervening couplets formed into a stanzaic pattern of **aab**, repeating the compositional features of 202-211 (**b**'s: 218-219, 220-221, 222-223).

226-229: stanza in **aab** formed by semantic contrast between lines that describe a customary series of events (**a**'s: 226-228, cultivate, plant, weed, ripen) and a single line that describes an unexpected outcome (**b**: 229, the cultivators steal).

He said, "Let them go and cultivate Kashaka of the copses.
They will turn it to bare earth.
I tell you, all of Kitendagulo
Will they turn to bare earth.
All of Lukulungo is theirs.
Let them turn it to bare earth.
And Gera,
Let them turn to bare earth.
I tell you, Kashalazi,
Let them totally redden it red."

They thank him, the Bahyoza,
They then take the road.
They reach the king of Kabale,
They wish to speak.

"He said, My Lord, go cultivate,
Cultivate Kiziba.
All of Kashaka,
He says the King should turn to bare earth.
All of Lukulungo,
Also will he turn to bare earth.
All of Gera,
Also will redden completely red."

He sounded the drum. They attended. "Quickly! Go and dig!" he said.
They dug, the men of Kaitaba.
After they dug, they broadcast seed.
They chop weeds briskly, briskly.

The sorghum ripens.
They yearn to steal in great harvest baskets.
But others come, they tattle.
They say, "Lord, *Hunter of the steppes*,
While you sit here,
Bahyoza finish off your sorgham."

Ahi, "Bagye balime Kashaka k' enshaka.
Balagihindula nkuuto.
Nkugambile Katendagulo yona
Balagihindula nkuuto.
Lukulungo yabo yona.
Bagihindule nkuuto.
Na Gera,
Bagihindule nkuuto.
Nkugambile Kashalazi,
Bagitukuze katuku."

Basiima Omuhyoza,
Baija bateka omu kihanda.
Bamugoba omukama wa Kabale,
Bagonza kugamba.

"Ngu waitu Mugende mulime,
Mulime Kiziba.
Kashaka yona,
Ngu mukama agihindule nkuuto.
Lukulungo yona,
Na yonene alagihindula nkuuto.
Gera yona,
Na yonene etukule katuku."

Yailaya. Bamugoba. Ati, "Iloko mulime."

Balima abashaija ba Kaitaba.
Kabalimile babiba.
Babagala bwangu bwangu.

Gwahya omugusha.
Bagonza kwibil' omu bitukulu.
Baija babalega.
Bati, "Waitu *Kishwaga-Malungu*,
Mbali oli aha,
Abahyoza bamala omugusha gwawe."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 250-267:
When the warriors drink the sorghum beer, they want to go out cattle raiding and encourage Kaitaba to allow them; but his answers to their bellicose praise speak only of peaceful matters. Other warriors devise a plan toward the same end: they will stir up hostilities with a neighboring king by concocting a report of slander.

NOTES

252 Slasher: That is, one who divides an enemy's herd to drive it off as spoils. It appears this is a praise name made for the nonce, as the elision between noun and verb falls on the verbal ending rather than on the pre-prefix of the noun; thus, it is translated without hyphens.

257 Bugengele: A village in Kihanja kingdom. This foreshadows events to come - he already has Kihanja on his mind.

POETIC STANZAS

234-243: two stanzas (234-239, 240-243) that mirror one another through repetition and paraphrase; each stanza has three parts; the first corresponding part is a couplet (a:234-235 and 240-241) associated by paraphrasing of "go"and "summon" (234, 240) and repeating the proper name (235, 241) and is doubled in the first stanza (236-237); the second corresponding part is a couplet (238-239 and 242-243) whose first lines repeat the stems "come,""remove,"and "witchcraft" (238,242) and whose final lines diverge (239, 243).

244-247: after a figure that compounds repetition with double verb and chained repetition (244-245), there is a stanza in **abab** created by repetition and parallelism (245-247).

248-251: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines that consist of dependant clauses beginning in Ka- "when" (**a**'s: 248, 250) and lines that consist of main clauses (**b**'s: 249, 251).

252-255: stanza in **abab** by repetition and parallelism.

256-259: stanza in **aabb** with couplets coherent by parallelism and repetition

260-263: stanza alternately in **abbc** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a verb inflected as a relative (**b**'s: 261, 262) and lines that do not, and in **aabb** formed by couplets that cohere syntactically by enjambment (260-261) and semantically by cause and effect (262-263).

He said, "I am fearful. Go and find me
Katogoita, child of Kibingaila of Igombe village.
Find me Katogoita,
Katogoita, child of Kibingaila of Igombe village.
Have him come draw out the sorcery. The Baziba do not like us.
They would kill my men."

They went and they summoned him,
Katogoita, child of Kibingaila of Igombe village.
He came, he drew out the sorcery that day.
He did not leave a bit.

They reap the sorgham, they reap it,
They reap it. But of the gleanings,
They do not set aside a royal portion.
Of the wrapped-up bundles
They come and set aside the royal portion,
Which, when they stored it in the rear pantry,
Reached to the royal vestibule.

When they drank it, it seized them:
Bahyoza want the words and deeds of war.

If he with kingly gestures drew attention to himself, they'd say, "You are the *Cutter of cattle herds* .
If you drew our attention to a bamboo grove, we'd cut it truly, truly."
If with kingly gestures he drew attention to himself, they'd say, "You are the *Cutter of cattle herds* .
If you drew our attention to a forest, we'd cut it swiftly, swiftly."

He said, "Tell me of our neighbors,
Tell me of Bugengele villagers,
At the home of Nyawela,
At the home of the king's man Byalushengo.

Others spoke in the courtyard guard-house
Called the place of the Balwani clan.
With the force that brought them there they said, "The king has drunk a lot of beer!
He might free us to mount a raid.

Ahi, "Nintina. Mugende mumpigile
Katogoita ka Kibingaila Igombe.
Mpigila Katogoita,
Katogoita ka Kibingaila Igombe
Aij' aihye amalogo. Abaziba tibatwenda.

Bakwit' abashaija bange."

Bagya bamweta,
Katogoita ka Kibingaila Igombe.
Yaija yagaihya amalogo kil' ekyo.
Tiyasigile na kantu.

Bagesha bagesha,
Bagesha ag' enjulunga
Tibagabile lwa Nyangoma.
Ag' omu bitende bonene
Baija bagabila lwa Nyangoma.
Kabagaba omu mugamba,
Gashohola nyalushasi.

Kabaganywa gabakwata:
Abahyoza bagonza eby' okutabala.

Kayayetengya bati, "Atem' ente n' iwe.

Kawakutengya olubingo tulutema bwoli bwoli."

Kayayetengya bati, "Atem' ente n' iwe.

Kawakutengya ekibila tukitema bwangu bwangu."

Ahi, "Ndaga aba ns' eli,
Ndaga aba Bugengele,
Omwa Nyawela,
Omw' omushaija Byalushengo.

Bati kabali omu kaju k' eilembo
Akobalikweta Bulawani.
Agobakagenzile bagya babagambila bati, "Mukama yanywa amalwa gangi!
Yakutaishula kutabaala.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 268-296:
They come to Kaitaba, greet him, and assert that several citizens of Kihanja Kingdom, including the king himself, have greatly insulted him.

NOTES

283 Muhamba: Collective name for residents of Kihanja kingdom.

287 Kahigi: King of Kihanja kingdom.

289 Kabale: the location of Kaitaba's palace, seat of Kyamutwala kingdom.

290 Mayondwe: location of Kahigi's palace, seat of Kihanja kingdom.

292 He-who-Speaks-with-Bullish-Roar: praise name refers to Kaitaba.

293 Bwogi: Kaitaba's grandfather.

295 Ilimamoshe: Kaitaba's grandmother.

296 Milembe: Kaitaba's wife; her name means "Peace."

POETIC STANZAS

264-267: stanza in **aa**a**b** formed by contrast between lines that cohere by enjambment (264-266) and a marked single line that stands alone and begins with three similarly inflected verbs and ends with an adverbial repeated three times.

267-269: note *bwoli* on either side of enanga solo (see the same figure in lines 17, 21)

270-277: two stanzas (270-273, 274-277) that cohere by repetition and parallelism and are similarly formed in **aa**a**b**; the first stanza is formed in **aa**a**b** by contrast between one line that has an indicative verb (**b**: 273) and three lines that do not (**a**'s: 270-272); the second stanza is formed in **aa**a**b** by contrast between one line that repeats a line from the previous stanza (**b**: 277), and three lines that do not (**a**'s: 274-276).

278-281: stanza in **a**a**ba'** formed by contrast between lines in which agali "[the news] of"is explicit (**a**'s: 278, 279, 281) and one in which it is implied (**b**: 280)

284-288: stanza in **ab**a**ab** formed by contrast between lines that are composed as juma "insult" + personal name (or reversed, **a**'s: 284, 286, 287) and lines that are composed solely of praisenames (285, 288).

289-292: stanza in **aabb** formed by couplets, that both begin with locutives and cohere by enjambment; the first also coheres by repetition of twalila "rule" (**a**'s: 289-290) and the second by the occurrence of praisenames (**b**'s: 291-292).

293-296: stanza in **abab** by repetition and parallelism.

For many days now, Bahyoza
We have not eaten a bit of meat,
And this eating without sauce is killing us.
Go make him think that he's been slandered mightily, mightily, mightily."

[Enanga Solo]

They did not ask another word.
I saw them come mightily, mightily, mightily.

With the force that brought them, "Live forever, *Father-creator* ,
Live forever, *Bull who stamps smudge fires*.
Live forever, *Provider* ,
Live forever, you are *Owner of the drum and of salutations of respect*.

Live forever, *Ancient boar*,
Live forever, *Child of Makes hunters wary*.
Live forever, *Leaf of the Mushula plant*,
Live forever, *Bull who stamps smudge fires*.

He answered, "Tell me of the news abroad,
Of Bugengele, Byalushengo's home,
Of Musila village of Luhungu,
Of Ntoboola and Bugengele."

They said, "Lord, as we sit here eating and drinking,
The Muhamba studies slander."

They say, "He has abused you, Nkwelele,
Lord, *Defeater of attempts to turn him back*
And more are you abused by Bitalaho of Mujwiga,
And King Kahigi himself abuses you,
The *Orphan of Lugomola*.

He says the dominion of Kabale
He'll dominate from Mayondwe.
He says he is the *Lake that swallows rivers*
Especially those of *He who speaks with a bullish roar*.

He says they could not salute Bwogi,
Then turn and salute you.
They could not salute Ilimamoshe,
Then turn and salute Milembe."

Twamala ebilo bingi ichwe Omuhyoza
Leba tutaikulya kanyama.
N' obunyata bwatwita.
Mugende mugye mumujumisilize bwoli bwoli bwoli."

[Enanga Solo]

Tibabaliz' ekindi.
Nkabona baija bwoli bwoli.

Agobaizile, "Kamelele, *Ishowanga*,

Kamelele, *Enumi ya Kijunga-Makomi*.
Kamelele, *Lugaba*,
Kamelele, oli *Kagila-Ngoma-na-Bilamyo*.

Kamelele, *Mpunu Nkulu*,
Kamelele, *Iwa Kabakengya*.
Kamelele, *Kyai Ky' omushula*,
Kamelele, *Enumi ya Kijunga-Makomi*.

Ahi, "Ndaga agali ns' eli,
Agali Bugengele omwa Byalushengo,
Musila kya Luhungu,
Agali Ntoboola na Bugengele."

Bati, "Waitu nitulya nitunywa,
Omuhamba yayega kulogota."

Bahi, "Yakujuma Nkwelele,
Waitu *Kilema-Mahindula*.
Washuba wajumwa Bitaliho bya Mujwiga,
Na Kahigi nakujuma,
Entabwa ya Lugomola.

Ngu obutwalila Kabale
Wenene alabutwalila Mayondwe.
Ngu n' iwe *Nyanja Emil' Emiga*
Leba eya *Kajuga-Magundu*.

Ngu tibalamye Bwogi,
Bakagaluka bakalamya na iwe
Tibalamye Ilimamoshe,
Bakagaluka bakalamya Milembe."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 297-315:
Kaitaba becomes angry and seeks the counsel of his wife, who comes from Kihanja.

Lines 316-329:
She warns him of the strength of the Kihanjan military, whereupon he questions her loyalty, but she insists she is loyal to him.

NOTES

300 Plant soon to bear: see line 380 below, where the terms of this abuse seem to be expanded.

POETIC STANZAS

297-302: compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, in **abb**, formed by contrast between a single couplet whose lines begin with adverbials (the subordinating particle *ka-* "when"and the formulaic phrase kil' ekyo) and consist of 3rd person narration (**a**:297-298) and two couplets whose initial lines begin with locutives and contain the stem *juma* insult (**b**'s: 299-300, 301-302).

303-307: stanza in **aabb** formed into 3 couplets - 303-304, 304-305, 306-307 - by the unusual dual function of 304, which serves as both final line of the first couplet and the initial line of the second couplet; the couplets cohere, respectively, by an intra-line, threefold repetition of a final word or phrase (303-304), by an inter-line lexical repetition of "My wife Milembe" (304-305), and composition as praisenames.

308-315: verse of two stanzas (308-311, 312-315), both in **abab**, that share the same final lines; the first is formed by contrast between lines that begin with a locutive (**a**'s: 308, 310) and those that begin with the formulaic phrase *kil' eki* "This day" (**b**'s: 309, 311); the second stanza is formed by contrast between lines that begin with a locutive and contain the stem tabala "make war upon" (**a**'s: 312, 314) and those that do not (**b**'s: 313, 315).

316-325: compound stanza in **aba'**, 2 + 6 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that share the stems tabala "make war" + malenga "foolishness" */zana/* "play"in their first and second lines, respectively (**a**'s: 316-317, 324-325) and couplets formed on different compositional principles (**b**'s: 318-323); the middle six lines (the **b**'s) are formed as **abab** with the second **ab** sequence doubled, so that the figure could be represented **aba**(aa)**b**(bb) to indicate the expansions; in these six lines (318-323) **a**'s contain

[Enanga Solo]

I saw when the king unblinked his eyes,
That day, his pupils refused to be shut away again.
He said, "He heaps an elephant on me in abuse and then throws in the trap.
Ebibyalwa herb he changes me to a plant soon to bear.
He said, "He abuses me, that Kahigi
Orphans that no longer help one another."

I heard him say, "What shall I do, What shall I do, What shall I do?"
He said, "My wife Milembe, Milembe, Milembe,
You, my wife, Milembe,"

He said, *"Child of Kagoloile*
Of the Unbreached shields of Nyamatiti."

He said, "Quickly bring my bow and quiver.
On this very day, I'll go plundering at Migongo."
He said, "He has abused me, that Kahigi.
This day I will exact from him the tribute of the full-grown bull."

She said, "Where do you go to raid, O King?
Quickly set my heart at ease."
He said, "I'm raiding your own Kihanja.
This day I will exact from him the tribute of the full grown bull."

She said, "Do not raid Kihanja like a fool,
Or as though it were a game."
She said, "He has his Mujumba troop, Cause of long-term injuries
And he has never used them up and never have they moved away.
She said, "He has men of Busingo and Bulembo villages.
There are as well the Death-Dealing Spearshafts."
She said, "And those he has never used up,
And those never have moved away."
She said, "If you raid foolishly,
The Muhamba knows how to play the game."

names of military battalions (318, 320, 321) and **b**'s contain negative verbs of using up or moving or both (319, 322, 323); to indicate the recursive expansions and

[Enanga Solo]

Nkabona kayabulwile omukama
Kil' ekyo emboni zayanga kuhokya
Ati, "Yanjumisa enjoju yantaho ebitimba.

Ebibyalwa yampindula ngembe.
Ahi, "Anjuma Kahigi
Entabwa Itakijumulana."

Nkahulila ahi, "Ngile ntai, ngile nta , ngile ntai?"

Ahi, "Mukazi wange, Milembe, Milembe, Milembe,
Iwe mukazi wange Milembe,"

Ahi, *"Lwa Kagoloile*
Ow' engabo Itajwa za Nyamatiti."

Ahi, "Yanguhya obuta n' ekilimba.
Kil' eki mbwenu inye ndainyaga Migongo."
Ahi, "Yanjuma Kahigi.
Kil' eki ndamuhongesa lwabinanga."

Ahi, "Nogya kutabala nkahai, Mukama?
Yanguha onyikize omyoyo."
Ahi, "Nintabala omwanyu Kihanja.
Kil' eki ndamuhongesa lwabinanga."

Ahi, "Kihanja otakutabalamu bya malenga,
Bwangili bya kuzana."
Ati, "Agil' Omujumba *Kalabashegya* -

Tikabalyaga tibakagyaga hantu.

Ati, "Agila aba Busingo na Bulembo.
Abalimu Mango ikambulaine -"
Ahi, "Na bonene takabalyaga
Na bonene tibakagyaga hantu."
Ahi, "Kolatabalamu bya malenga,
N' Omuhamba amanya kuzana."

embeddings, the entire compound stanza could be represented **ab**(aba(aa)b(bb))**a'**.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 330-369:
To prepare his raid, he engages diviners, but they see only a state of peace between Kaitaba's Kyamutwala and Kahigi's Kihanja. Still angered by the alleged insult, he sets out to raid Kihanja anyway; but once there he does not pursue violence.

NOTES

333 Enpayula: Walnut-sized fruits used when green with ritual preparation and stirred briskly in a water-filled earthenware vessel to gain knowledge made otherwise inaccessable by time, space, or personal agency.

336 Infusing the churns: part of the usual set of dairy practices; evidently no havoc is foretold: a bad sign for the would-be attackers.

337 Okyela: literally, "Large White One," the name of the second *mufumu*, fortune-teller and healer of diseases of the spirit; he is a specialist in the oracle of the chicken.

POETIC STANZAS

326-329: 326-29: stanza alternately in **aa**a**b** formed by contrast between lines that contain the stem shenda "depose" (**a**'s:326-328) and a line that does not (**b**:329); or in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines spoken by the king (326-327) and those spoken by his wife (**b**'s: 328-329); or in a**aba'** formed by contrast between lines with verbs inflected in the 2nd person (**a**'s: 326, 327, 329) and a line inflected in the 3rd person (**b**: 328).

330-333: stanza in **aabb** composed of couplets that cohere, respectively, by enjambment and repetition.

330-348: verse passage in **abaa**b formed by contrast between stanzas whose initial lines are composed as "he summoned".../praisename or proper name (**a**'s: 330-333, 337-340, 341-344) and stanzas whose initial line is composed as "When (they divined) they saw (them) in the milking room..." (**b**'s: 334-336, 345-348); the type **a** stanzas are formed in **aabb**: 330-333 in couplets that cohere, respectively, by enjambment and repetition; 337-340 in couplets that cohere, respectively, by chaining and enjambment; in 341-344 the initial couplet coheres by enjambment, while the other couplet - and the series of type **a** stanzas as a whole - is finalized by a line with an initial formulaic phrase kil' eki mbwenu and semantic, rather than syntactic, coherence with the preceding line; this finalization creates incremental repetition, which is replicated in the two type **b** stanzas: 334-336 is formed in **aab** by contrast between initial lines that cohere by repetition and a final line that does not and that begins with a placename (as the two previous lines began with verbs); 341-344 is formed in **aabb**; a previous triplet (334-336) has been condensed to form the initial couplet (341-342) that coheres by parallelism (present continuitive verbs in final positions); the following couplet, the king's warlike outburst, finalizes the stanza by semantic contrast and the passage as a whole by incremental repetition.

[Enanga Solo]

I heard him say, "You would depose me, wife of mine.
You would depose me, my wife Milembe."
She said, "The word that would depose you, be lost forever!
Quickly! Go and set the land aflame. Turn it to bare earth."

I heard him summon. He summoned him,
Trial-maker of Deserted-one.
He said, "Roil up the oracle waters, let me see.
Let *empayula* roil up the waters."

When they had roiled them up they saw a royal dairy room, a dairy room.
They saw them in the dairy churning,
In Mwejanjala village infusing the churns with smoke.

He summoned Okyela,
Okyela of Kagenzi Buhunga.
He said, "Go seize the rooster that crows at dawn
Before the royal bathers have brought my water."

Then he summoned Porcupine Ncheeka
Of Balilemwa Buhunga.
He said, "Quickly! You too! Do the oracle of grass.
This very day I want to go to war."

When they consulted it, they saw them in the dairy churning,
In Mweyanjala village infusing smoke.
He said, "Enough! Close up the chickens! I go to war!
All that's left is to descend on Bugingo's village."

[Enanga Solo]

Nkahulila ati, "Wakunshenda, mukazi wange.
Wakunshenda mukazi wange Milembe."
Ati, "Eky' okukushenda nikikabule!

Iloko ogyoke. Ogihindule nkuuto."

Nkahulila yabilikila. Yamubilikila
Anyanyia ya Kalugwa.
Ahi, "Tabangula ndebe.
Itabangule empayula."

Kabaitabangwile babona kagagala kagagala.

Bababona kagagala nibachunda,
Mwejanjala nibotela ebishabo.

Yabilikila Okyela,
Kyela kya Kagenzi Buhunga.
Ati, "Ogende okwate enkoko olukyakya
Abajubu batakanabwile."

Yabilikilaho Kishegeshe Ncheeka
Ekya Balilemwa Bugunga.
Ahi, "Iloko naiwe oteke olushungu.
Kil' eki mbwenu nagonza kutabaala."

Kabateka babona kagagala nibachunda,

Mweyajala nibotela.
Ahi, "Nyabula! Bund' enkoko zange! Ntabale!
Ekilasigalila ndasongokela kya Bugingo."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 370-407:
The warriors renew their report of insult and add to it. Now enraged, Kaitaba informs his wife of his intent and then sets several villages on fire.

NOTES

377 Intruder: Literally, "one who goes inside;" the word is used equally for an adulterous male lover or for one who sleeps with a recently widowed woman.

POETIC STANZAS

349-371: verse passage in **aba'** formed by two pairs of stanzas (**a**'s: 349-352 + 353-359 and 364-367 + 368-371), each cohering by substantial repetition of the final two lines of the first stanza as the first two lines of the second stanza, contrasted with a single intervening stanza (**b**: 360-363) formed in **abab** by contrast between lines that begin with "Let me tell you..." (**a**'s: 360, 362) and lines that do not (**b**'s: 361, 363); lines 337-339 are appended reiterations and transformations of the previous line type, which ends in a placename.

372-379: verse of mirror stanzas in **abba** (372-375, 376-379) that share final lines (375,379) and that are formed by repetition between middle lines (**b**'s: 373-374, 377-378) not shared with first and last lines (**a**'s: 372,375 and 377,378).

In Kabale he did not rest that night.
He marched and rested in Bugengele.
I saw him descend.
The king did not ask at all.

My lord, my lord, he descended that day,
He did not ask at all.
There he is at Nsisha.
There he is at Kigoye.
There he is at Kaishelukindo.
Iyo-o at Byazi.
And Matembe.

Let me tell you: at Kihilila and Kyebyazi,
At Kanyinayo,
Let me tell you: Paddles caught them on the hip.
He did not ask another word.

Iyo-o at Kishogo,
At Kyaisil' engo,
The king spent eight days there:
Lo! he does not wish to go to war.

[Interruption]

The king spent eight days there:
He never spoke a warlike word.
Again they said, "What can we do with him?
Again let's make him think that he's been slandered."

They said, "Although you've come,
The Muhamba has abused you.
Abused you, the sardonic Muhamba has,
He says, my lord, you did not come for war.

When your brother Kabushumba (died),
My lord, you came as an intruder.
He says you came to intrude inside, my lord,
He says, my lord, you did not come for war.

[Enanga Solo]

Kabale tiyagilaile
Akagya yagilala Bugengele.
Nkabona yasoka.
Omukama tiyabaliz' akantu.

Waitu waitu yasoka kil' ekyo,
Tiyabaliz' akantu.
Niw' ogwo omuli Nsisha.
Niw' ogwo omuli Kigoye.
Niw' ogwo omuli Kaishelukindo.
Iyo-o Omu Byazi.
Na Matembe.

Nkugambile: Kihilila na Kyebyazi,
Kanyinayo,
Nkugambile: engahi yamugwa omu itundu.
Tiyabaliz' ekindi.

Iyo-o Omuli Kishogo,
Kyaisil' engo,
Omukama akamala ebilo munana:
Leba atalikwenda kutabaala.

[Interruption]

Omukama akamala ebilo munana:
Atakahangaga bya kutabaala.
Bashuba bati, "Wenene tugile tuta?
Tushube tumujumisilize."

Bati, "Ngu olwo waizile,
Omuhamba yakujuma.
Yakujuma Omuhamba Ilula,
Ngu Waitu tiwaizile kutabaala.

Olwo mulumuna wawe Kabushumba (yafile),
Waitu okaija oli kitahilize.
Ngu okaija kutahilila waitu,
Ngu waitu tiwaizile kutabaala.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 408-425:
When Kihanja's King Kahigi hears of this, he offers tribute and hospitality in an attempt to assuage Kaitaba's anger, sending a messenger to negotiate.

NOTES

382 Planted-ones: praisename for *enkuku* beans, a food traditionally reserved for consumption by the ruling clans.

403 Time of peace: that is, he did not set the land aflame without reason; this is possibly a pun, for Kaitaba's wife's name is Peace (*Milembe*).

407 Slaughter Mountain: the place where an earlier king of Kianja, Kalemela, executed enough men to make blood flow from the top to the base.

410 Fall upon the launderers: That is, he brings damage and discord unexpectedly.

POETIC STANZAS

380-387: verse of two stanzas, both in **abab**, (380-383, 384-387) formed, respectively, by parallelism and repetition (**a**'s: 380, 382; **b**'s: 381, 383) and repetition alone (of initial locutive and final preposition, **a**'s: 384, 386; **b**'s: 385, 387).

388-392: stanza in **aba**a**b** formed between contrast between lines composed as verb initial + personal name (**a**'s: 388, 390, 391) and lines that lack a main verb, being composed of praisename and descriptors, respectively (**b**'s: 389, 392).

404-407: stanza in **abab** formed by contrast between lines with initial double verbs (**b**'s: 405, 407) and those with single initial verbs (**a**'s: 404, 406).

408-411: stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between lines composed as hulila "heard" + Kahigi... (**a**'s: 408, 409) and lines composed of praisenames alone

414-417: stanza alternately in **abab** formed by contrast between lines lexically composed as locutive + honga "pay tribute" + "cattle"(**a**'s: 414, 416) and lines that contain "pay tribute" + "weapons" in different order (**b**'s: 415, 417); and in **aa**a**b** formed by lines syntactically composed as active, subjunctive verb + direct object (**a**'s:414-416) contrasted with with a single line composed as subject + passive, indicative verb (**b**: 417).

He says you came when beans were being planted,
Now lo! they are soon to bear.
You came when *Planted-ones* were being planted,
Lo! now they are thick with foliage.

He says the dominion of Kabale–he himself,
He'll dominate from Mayondwe.
He says one kingship is like another–he himself,
He doesn't fear a thing.

He abused you, that Lukwelele,
The *Defeater of attempts to turn him back*.
You were abused by the child of Galengaine.
You were abused even more by Balongo
And by that medium of Mugasha you made payment to.

They say they could not salute Bwogi,
And then salute you."

Rage took hold of him.
He said, "Send to Bwogi,
Child of Unbreached shields of Nyamatiti."

[Enanga Solo]

They sent to Bwogi
Child of Unbreached shields of Nyamatiti."

They said, "Stand at Kalabagaine and see
How he has gone to set the land aflame."
He said, "And to my wife send also,
Let her not say, 'He set the land aflame in time of peace.'"

When dawn appeared he set flame to Ndama.
He turned and set flame to Kabilizi.
He went to Slaughter Mountain and set it aflame.
He returned and set flame to Slaughter Mountain.

When he heard of this, Kahigi,
Heard he Kahigi, *Nomadic beast of the steppes*.
Gluey gum tree you fall upon the launderers.
They touched my head. *Dead of night he fears not*.

He said, "What shall I do, my friend? I hear royal drums
That seem to me like those of *The Hunter of the Steppes*. "

He said, "Shall I pay tribute in cattle?
Or shall I pay in weaponry?"
They say, "Lord, pay the tribute in cattle.
Weaponry, Lord, is never paid in tribute."

Ngu okaija empelege nibabyala,
Mbwenu leba zaba kigembe.
Okaija *Embyabwa* nibabyala,
Leba mbwenu zaba mushokolo.

Ngu obutwalile Kabale wenene
Leba alabutwalila Mayondwe
Ngu obukama nk' obundi wenene,
Takitina na kantu.

Yakujuma Lukwelele,
Wenene *Kilema-mahindula*.
Wajumwa kya Galengaine.
Washuba wajumwa na Balongo.
N' ekibandwa ekyo wahongeile Mugasha.

Ngu bonene tibakulamya Bwogi,
Bakagaluka bakalamya na iwe."

Obushungu bwamukwata.
Ahi, "Ntumila ali Bwogi,
Ow' engabo Itajwa za Nyamatiti."

[Enanga Solo]

Bamutuma ali Bwogi
Ow' engabo Itajwa za Nyamatiti."

Bati, "Oyemelele Kalabagaine obone
Okwo yagya kwokyamu."
Ahi, "N' omukazi wange mumutume,
Agende atakugil' ati, 'Akagyokya bwa Milembe.'"

Kabwakeile yayokya Ndama.
Yagaluka yayokya Kabilizi.
Yagya Magango yagyokya.
Yashuba yayokya na Magango.

Kayahulila Kahigi wenene,
Yahulila Kahigi, *Nyamaishwa ebulilwe obutuulo*,
Kikanshe otomyela abogya,
Bakankol' Omutwe, *Mwilima gw' ensimbazi tagutina*.

Ahi, "Ngile ntai bojo? Nimpulila enkoito
Ezonizishana za *Kishwaga-Malungu*."

Ahi, "Mpong' ente?
Bwangili mpong' ebikwato?"
Bati, "Waitu ohong' ente.
Ebikwato waitu tibikahongwaga."

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 426-453:
The messenger delivers Kahigi's offer, and Kaitaba demands retribution for the putative insult.

Lines 454-465:
Kahigi sends hundreds of cattle in hopes that Kaitaba will swallow his anger.

NOTES

420 Ihangilo: kingdom on the southern border of Kihanja.

421 Zinzaland: A state on the southern border of Ihangilo.

442 (taikutabala): a false start.

448 You drank your milk: Kaitaba compares Kahigi to a spoiled child.

451 Plant soon to bear: see above line 380-382.

POETIC STANZAS

418-441: verse passage in **aba'** formed by two 8-line stanzas (**a**'s: 418-425, 434-441) composed as introductory couplet (418-419, 434-435) + couplet substantially repeated from first to second stanza (420-421, 436-437) + quatrain formed in **abab** by different lexical repetitions within in each stanza (422-425, 438-441), contrasted with an 8-line stanza (**b**: 426-433) which coheres between its various lines by enjambment, parallelism and repetition.

442-447: compound stanza in **aba'**, 2 + 2 + 2, by contrast between couplets whose lines begin second person locutive.../ "this day"...(**a**'s: 442-443, 446-447, although the line division is varied, as it is in the immediately preceding passage - compare 422-423 and 424-425) and a single couplet that substantially repeats part of the preceding passage (**b**: 444-445 repeats 420-421 and 436-437).

448-453: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2; formed by contrast between couplets whose first lines begin with the same locutive, and whose verbs - 2 in every line - are all inflected in the 2nd person singular (**a**'s: 448-449, 450-451) and a single couplet whose first line begins with the same locutive, but whose verb - a single one in the second line alone - is inflected in the 3rd person negative.

To his man, Goatskin
He said, "Quickly. Go and salute him.
Say, 'When you were raiding Ihangilo,
Or Buzinza of Mankolongo,
You would send to him, and he would cook Bahyoza plantains,
So they could end their hunger.'
Say, 'Why now did you not send to him, so he could cook Bahyoza
Plantains to end their hunger?'"

Goatskin did not ask another word.
He came fearfully.
And when he cast his eyes on him,
(Calves) that do not hinder, *Thighs that bring no shame*
"Long life to the *Calves*
Of He who stamps smudge fires.
Long life to *Those that do not hinder*.
Long life to the *Wide strider of the steppe*.

Kahigi salutes you.
The *Orphan of Lugomola* salutes you.
He says when you were raiding Ihangilo
Or Buzinja of Mankolongo,
You would send to him,
So he could cook Bahyoza plantains.
Why now did you not send to him
So he could cook Bahyoza plantains?"

He answered, "Say to him, 'A messenger is never slain,
Otherwise, this day, today, he would have had me killed.'
Say, 'He is not raiding Ihangilo
Or Buzinja of Mankolongo.'
Say, 'You abused him. Now this day
He will make you pay the tribute of the full-grown bull.

He says that when you drank your milk you spit up on your belly.
You spoke again and you abused him.
He says you abused him elephantinely; you badly threw him down.
You transformed him, transformed him to a plant soon to bear.
He says now, this day, today,
He's not going to Buzinja.'"

The man then went. He told this to Kahigi,
The *Orphan of Lugomola*.

Yagila omushaija Kahu ka mbuzi
Ahi, "Iloko ogende ogye omulamye.
Oti, 'Olwo oba notabala Ihangilo,
Bwangili Buzinja omwa Mankolongo,
Nk' omutumaho akachumbila Abahyoza ebitoke,

Bakaleka kulambala.'
Ohi, 'Kiki mbwenu kutamutumaho akachumbila Abahyoza

Ebitoke bakaleka kulambala.'"

Kahu ka mbuzi tiyabaliz' ekindi.
Akaija nyainyai.
Agoyamutaileho amaisho,
Itamulema, *Mabelo Gutamugoola*
"Kamelele *Mfundo*
Eya Kijunga-Makomi.
Kamelele *Itamulema*
Kamelele *Lwagagila-Malungu*.

Nakulamya Kahigi.
Nakulamya *Entabwa ya Lugomola*.
Ngu olw' otabala Ihangilo
Bwangili Buzinja omwa Mankolongo,
Nk' omutumaho,
Akachumbila Abahyoza ebitoke.
Kiki mbwenu kutamutumaho
Akachumbila Abahyoza ebitoke?"

Ahi, (taikutabala) "Oti, 'Entumwa teitwa,
Kil' eki mbwenu le yakwisile inye.'
Ohi, 'Taikutabala Ihangilo
Bwangili Buzinja omwa Mankolongo.'
Oti, 'Omujumile. Mbwenu kil' eki
Alakuhongesa lwabinanga.

Ngu k'owanywa amata okachwela enda.

Washuba wajuma na iwe.
Ngu wenene omujumisiz' enjoju; wamutaho ekilule ekibi.

Wamuhindula, wamuhindula ngembe.

Ngu mbwenu kilo ekya mbwenu,
Wenene talikugya na Buzinja.'"

Omushaija akagenda. Yagya yabimugambila Kahigi,
Entabwa ya Lugomola.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 466-489:
Kaitaba challenges the warriors who drive the cattle to him, but they are conciliatory. Kaitaba sends a parting message of warning to Kahigi.

NOTES

460 Cut a long staff...: a common proverb that compares a long walking staff used peacefully with a short stick carried under the arm used as a weapon or as a symbol of political power.

489 ENANGA MELODY CHANGES AFTER THIS LINE: as does the stanzaic structure.

POETIC STANZAS

456-461: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2; formed by contrast between couplets that begin similarly and literally refer to cattle (**a**'s: 456-457, 458-459) and a single that begins as the others but ends with a proverb.

462-465: stanza in **aabb** formed by couplets that cohere by repetition and parallelism (**a**'s: 462-463) and chaining (**b**'s: 464-465), respectively.

466-469: stanza in **abab** formed by repetition and parallelism.

474-479: compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between couplets that constitute a question (**a**'s: 474-475, 476-477) and a single couplet that constitutes an answer (**b**: 478-479).

486-489: stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with a conditional particle (**a**'s: 486-488) and a single line that begins with a negative imperative (**b**: 489). _

Kahigi took a hundred and a hundred and a hundred cattle. "These are Bwogi's," he said.
"And these cattle are Matiti's."
He took a hundred and a hundred. "These are to swallow your anger,
My king" he said.
He took a hundred and a hundred. "Cut a long staff from the forest," he said,
"A short one puts an end to men."

He said, "These cattle are Bwogi's
And these cattle are Milembe's."
He said, "Let him go slaughter them now, that one.
That one will have nothing more to say."

There they were driven by Kikwelele,
The king's man, *Defeater of attempts to turn him back*.
There they were driven by Kishumi, Kishumi,
Who wipes the dust from a bull's shoulders.

With what force they greeted as they still approached!
"Live forever *Bull that stamps smudge fires* ."
He said, "You? Who are you?"
He said, "I am Kishumi, *I wipe the dust from a bull's shoulders*. "

He said, "Now why did you abuse me?
This day I just might kill you, my man."
He continued, "Sir, if you wipe the dust from a bull's shoulders,
Come and wipe my face."
He answered, "What would there be to wipe, *Father-creator* ?
Surely a Hinda woman wiped it long ago."

He said, "But why did you abuse me?"
He answered, "My lord, may the word be lost forever
That slanders a king like you."
And Lukwelele said the same.
That day they denied blame swiftly, swiftly.

He said, "Go and tell Kahigi.
Say, 'He has forgiven you this day.
When you hear the small drum sound from Kanguge,
When he returns, he will make you pay the tribute of the full-grown bull.
When he is returning from the raid,
Do not take aim on him from a mountain overlook.'"

Yagila igana igana igana ati, "Ezi za Bwogi.

Ezi 'nte za Matiti."
Yagila igana igana ati, "Ezi mil' ekiniga,

Mukama wange."
Yagila igana igana ati, "Shala enkoni enda;

Engufi emala abantu."

Ati, "Ezi nte za Bwogi manti
Ezi nte za Milembe."
Ati, "Mbwenu agy' ateme wenene.
Wenene takigamba na kigambo."

Kazaijwamu Kikwelele,
Omushaija, *Kilema-Mahindula*.
Zaijwamu Kishumi, Kishumi,
Alagaza enumi omu mabango

Agoyakasingile akyaija!
"Kamelele Enumi ya *Kujunga-Makomi*."
Ati, "Iwe? Oli owai, iwe mushaija?"
Ati, "N' inye Kishumi, *ndagaza enumi omu mabango*."

Ati, "Mbwenu okanjumilaki?
Kil' eki nakukwita mushaija."
Ahi, "Waitu olwo olagaza enumi omu mabango,

Oije olagaze omu buso bwange."
Ahi, "Ndagazemuki Ishowanga?

Manti omuhindakazi akalagaza ila."

Atisi, "Onjumileki?"
Ati, "Waitu nkikabule
Eky'okulogota mukama nka iwe."
Na Lukwelele kwakwo.
Kil' ekyo bayetonga bwangu bwangu.

Ati, "Mugye mugile Kahigi
Muti, 'Yakugalulila kil' ekya bwile izoba.
K'olihulila akagoma kajuga Kanguge
K' aligaluka alikuhongesa lwabinanga.

K'aliba natabaluguka,
Otaikumulengela lya kabanga.

PLOT OUTLINE

Lines 490-521:

The battle done, a warrior recites his self-praise, and in a coda the bard envisions the descendants of Kaitaba walking home after a battle.

NOTES

490 I am the weakened one…: thus begins the *okwebuga*, or improvised self-praise poem, of a member of the audience. {Weakened one}: this modesty signals a strategy in self-praise known as "making oneself small" and also refers to a chicken, the secondary totem of the Basaizi clan, with which the speaker is affiliated matrilaterally (his mother's mother's mother's clan). Chicken, clan, and reciter are all associated with the profession of the *bafumu*, healers of spiritually caused diseases. {Thunder}: has a special relationship with chicken which is alluded to here. {Sharpened points, iron hammers}: rooster spurs.

491 Hanging on the sternpiece: said to refer to leopard, a secondary totem of the Balwani clan, to which the reciter's mother belonged. {Bent me over}: an act associated with sorcery, as is the profession of the *bafumu*.

492 No fingers or claws, throwing stick, wooden crook: figurative references to the python (*nkolantima*, a secondary totem of the Bajubu clan, according to the reciter. {Fence chimes}: a reference to the court security duties of the Balwani clan (also above, lines 13 and 261).

496 Agitated one, White spot: praise names of the python used so that it will not answer the call of its literal name.

497 These (spears) are yours: A self-praise poem (*okwebuga*) was traditionally performed before the king while brandishing one's spear; the recitation signals one's readyness for combat on the king's behalf.

498 Push on: This epilogue envisions the Bahyoza warriors returning from their raid.

500 Mukotani: Closed Mouth.

[An audience member recites his own self praise]

I am the weakened one who stirs things about.
Thunder said, "I'll strike you!" I said,"You strike me?
I am the grower of sharpened points.
Iron hammers like a spirit medium's."
When I reached Uganda they refused me space in a canoe.
So I went by hanging on the sternpeice.
They brought me to Uganda, then bent me over.
They found hair had filled my anus.
I climb a tree but have no fingers or claws.
They jog the fence chimes and I ring.
I am a throwing stick. I pass through cracks in shields.
I am a wooden crook and lie among tree branches.
I come from Bugabo Kingdom, Kabale village of Katwange.
I am a child of the Balwani clan of Mahugulu village.
I am of Byanjweli river of Mashaija.
I am of Mikimba and Ntule.
And Kantema Kashamba and Kantundu of Mabiga.
I am the Gatherer.
I trust in the snake, the Agitated one, the White spot.
Conquor, Provider! These spears are yours.

[The singer resumes in a different melody and poetic form]

Push on, children.
Push on, children.

Push on, Mukotani,
Thunder that splits rocks.

Push on, Bwhama,
Bull that does not worry about his appearance.
And him I call child.

Push on, Lwaijumba Kikuba,
He who never swallows a grudge,
He came from Kalisa.

Push on, Munyaninga,
Giant spear of Nyababa.

Push on, child of Kayagi Kimuli,
And that one a child, a child.

Push on, Muntu of Kashaija,
Wheelings-about of a bull.

[Ebyebugo]

Ninye gajoisile aka lwazilinga.
Enkuba eti nkutele nti ontel' ota?
Inye ayamezile amashongola.
Nyondo nka embandwa.
Kamazile kugya Buganda obwato bwayanga.
Nkagenda akihinda ky' obwato.
Bangobya Buganda bagya bankunanya.
Bashanga byoyania bijwile luhende.
Nkub' omuti tingila byala na mpambo
Ibobo ly' ekigi batengya. Nintakya
Mujugujugu ndaba omu byatika by' engabo
5 Mba nkolomboizo ndala omu matagi.
Nduga Bugabo Kibale kya Katwenge.
Ndi w' Abalwani ba Mahugulu.
Ndi wa Byanjweli bya Mashaija.
Ndi wa Mikimba na Ntule.
Na Kantema Kashamba na Katundu ka Mabiga.
Ndi Kihulula.
Nyesiga enjoka Enshamangi Lukoko.
Kasinge Gawe Lugaba.

Self-Praise Poetry ends

Chuma abana.
Chuma abana.

Chuma Mukotani,
Nkuba Ayas' Eibale.

Chuma Bwahama,
Engundu ya Kajaaja.
Na wenene ngu mwana.

Chuma Lwaijumba Kikuba,
Omutamila Nzigu,
Akaluga Kalisa.

Chuma Munyaninga,
Kichumu kya Nyababa.

Chuma lwa Kayagi Kimuli,
Nawe mwana, mwana.

Chuma Muntu lwa Kashaija,
Mikebuko ya Ngundu.

NOTES

512 Kalokola, Lusanju: Rescuer, Crusher of houses.

515 :...praise not understood.

516 Lwendulu, Omuhinda: Of a wailing alarm, Hinda clansman.

518 Zili Omukwoga: a personal name from its position in the poem, but an unusual one, and one whose meaning is not apparent. _

Kalokola Lusanju,
And that one is a child.

They call him Kalokola,
Ihuwe tree of Busholo,
Mujuju tree . . .

And Lwendulu Omuhinda,
And that one is a child.

Zili Omukwoga,
And that one is a child.

They are crying, they are crying.
Push on, push on, children.

Kalokola Lusanju,
Na wenene mwana.

Bamweta Kalokola,
Ihuwe lya Busholo,
Njuju jeshemeilwe okutela eyabuganzi.

Na Lwendulu Omuhinda,
Na wenene mwana.

Zili Omukwoga,
Na wenene mwana.

Nibalila, nibalila.
Chuma chuma bana.